war return to Teheran where the Shah is expected in about a month from this. From the Shah's return we shall have the country in a better state and no doubt a good trade for some months to come. To oblige Mr Ruddeby I have drawn a bill on my father on demand for £20.–. .– this I hope my father will not object to paying and charging the amt to Charles' acct.

Pray write to me as often as possible and let me know when you receive my letters as I am told they keep them at the F. O. after they have received them. I do not blame them for keeping them a few days because it is not right that we should be able to send news home as fast as they can.

What is Twigg about? you never say a word about him. I believe you know that the Emperor of Russia sent him a very fine diamond ring for painting a picture of the Shah.

This town is growing very disorderly scarcely a night passes without some one getting wounded or killed fighting in the streets; this is no matter to us as they never think of touching an Englishman. The fights generally occur between drunken men and with the large Georgian daggers.[49]

[EDWARD BURGESS TO HIS MOTHER] *Tabreez, August 27, 1839*

My letters to Charles of last month and this will give you some account of the disturbances we have had here. I can not say that I cared much about them, except that I did not like the idea of my friends the Armenians being plundered and murdered, and that I might have thought it my duty to make common cause with them, it did not make much difference to me. The ringleaders have however been most severely punished and I do not think they will attempt it again. The Russian Consul was frightened out of his senses; Syeed Khan behaved very well, and Cooja Awak who you may recollect as being mentioned in the Portfolio and who was the grand cause of the row, shewed much courage. He met the crowd just as he was coming out of the Consul's house, and undismayed by their appearance he turned round to some three or four artillery men who were on guard at the house and called out "wourin" (strike!) and suiting the action to the word he snatched up a stick which was near and struck a man on the head with it. He was however instantly knocked down and had not Syeed Khan and his servants come forward and with the help of the guard dragged him into the consul's house he would very likely have been killed.

My visit to Ahar was not without its pleasures as well as its pains. The four days I remained in camp passed agreeably enough, but I do not think that I ever in

[49] Justin Perkins, op. cit., relates that these disorders were touched off by the insolence of a Russian Armenian to a group of native merchants.

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